UNIVERSIDAD TECNOLÓGICA DE CHIHUAHUA

Entornos Virtuales y Negocios Digitales

Inglés IX

Evidence 1-5. Listening Activity: Reported Speech, "Office Gossip"

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1. Listening (fill in the blanks)

Video: "Office Gossip Chapter I" — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t__Kbprp-8Y

The missing words are in **bold**. The sentences in reported speech are underlined.

Amanda: I **want** you to tell me everything. Please, give **me** all the details.
Alfred: Well… your boss is **not** single.
Amanda: I can't **believe** it.
Alfred: He **has** a family and three **children**. Are you **surprised**?
Amanda: What do you think?
Alfred: Well, I thought **you** knew.

Alfred: I want to tell you something about Amanda.
Tom: Tell me, I **am** all ears.
Alfred: It's about our boss. She **asked** me to give her all the details.
Tom: Go on.
Alfred: Well, I **told** her that the boss was not single and that he had a family.
Tom: And?
Alfred: I asked her if she **was** surprised.
Tom: What is the connection with the **meeting**?
Alfred: There is no connection. I **think** she is in love with the boss!
Tom: Don't be **silly**.

Amanda: I need to tell you **something**. You won't like it.
Juliet: What is it, Amanda?
Amanda: I asked Alfred to **tell me** everything about George.
Juliet: Great! He is so **cute**!
Amanda: Well, he told me the boss was not **single**!
Juliet: Excuse me!
Amanda: He said the boss had a family and three children.
Juliet: I can't believe it! He just **invited** me to have dinner in an Italian restaurant.
Amanda: If **I** were you, I wouldn't **accept** that invitation.

2. Parts of speech

Part of speech	Examples from the listening
Noun	boss, family, children, details, restaurant, invitation
Pronoun	I, you, me, she, he, her
Verb	tell, give, believe, think, invited, accept
Adjective	single, surprised, cute, silly, Italian
Adverb	well, so, just
Conjunction	and, if
Preposition	about, with, in

3. -ed / -ing adjectives

Adjective	Meaning in Spanish	It comes from the verb	Example
surprised	sorprendido(a)	to surprise	Amanda was surprised when she heard the news.
surprising	sorprendente	to surprise	The news about the boss was surprising.

Note: "surprised" is the -ed adjective that appears in the listening; "surprising" is its -ing form.

4. Imperative sentences

- Please, give me all the details.
- Tell me.
- Go on.
- Don't be silly.
- Excuse me!

5. Reported speech

5.1 Sentences in reported speech (underlined in the listening)

- She asked me to give her all the details.
- I told her that the boss was not single and that he had a family.

- I asked her if she was surprised.
- I asked Alfred to tell me everything about George.
- He told me the boss was not single.
- He said the boss had a family and three children.

5.2 Sentences in black changed to reported speech

Direct speech	Reported speech
Tom: "Don't be silly."	Tom told Alfred not to be silly.
Amanda: "You won't like it."	Amanda told Juliet that she wouldn't like it.
Juliet: "He is so cute!"	Juliet said that George was so cute.
Juliet: "He just invited me to have dinner in an Italian restaurant."	Juliet said that George had just invited her to have dinner in an Italian restaurant.

6. Questions about the listening

What was the gossip about? The gossip was about the boss, George. He was not single; he had a family and three children.

Who was in love with the boss? Juliet was in love with the boss. She thought he was cute, and he had just invited her to dinner.

What did Alfred think about Amanda? Alfred thought that Amanda was in love with the boss.

Why did Amanda want to know everything about the boss? Because her friend Juliet liked him. Amanda wanted the details to tell Juliet, not because she was in love with him.